HUMAN RESOURCES & COMPANY POLICIES

Remote and Hybrid Work Policy

Apex Global Technologies Inc. — Guidelines, Eligibility, Security, and First-Week Requirements

Effective Date: January 1, 2026 **Version:** 3.1 **Classification:** Confidential — Internal **Owner:** People Operations & IT Infrastructure

1. Policy Purpose and Scope

Apex Global Technologies embraces a hybrid-first operating philosophy that combines the flexibility of distributed work with the intentional collaboration of co-located office hubs. This policy outlines the standards, eligibility criteria, cybersecurity mandates, and attendance rules governing all remote and hybrid work arrangements.

2. Work Arrangement Categories and Eligibility

Every employee position at Apex is mapped to one of three official working arrangement classifications:

Classification	Attendance Cadence	Eligibility Criteria & Scope
Tier 1: Hybrid (Default)	3 Days On-Site / 2 Days Remote	Standard engineering, product, and operations staff located within 50 miles of a regional office hub.
Tier 2: Office-Centric	4–5 Days On-Site	Hardware engineering, physical facilities, security operations center (SOC) tier 1, and sensitive lab teams.
Tier 3: Fully Remote	0 Days On-Site (Periodic summits)	Roles explicitly hired outside commuting radius. Requires written VP of People Operations and Department Head approval.

3. New Hire Remote Work Restriction (First-Week Attendance Rule)

CRITICAL POLICY: Mandatory In-Person Onboarding Period

Can a new employee work remotely during their first week?

NO. Under official Apex policy, newly hired employees are **strictly prohibited from working remotely during their initial onboarding period**, which encompasses their **first ten (10) consecutive business days (two full calendar weeks)**.

All newly hired personnel must report in-person to their assigned corporate office hub every business day during Weeks 1 and 2. This mandatory on-site attendance is non-negotiable and designed to facilitate:

- Physical identity verification, tax documentation (Form I-9) execution, and security badge issuance.
- Direct, hands-on laptop provisioning, biometric YubiKey MFA enrollment, and local environment debugging with IT Desktop Support.
- Dedicated face-to-face mentorship and pair programming with their designated Onboarding Buddy.
- Direct immersion into team standups, architectural deep dives, and company cultural norms.

> *Exception Clause:* Only candidates formally recruited and hired under an explicit Tier 3 (Designated Fully Remote) employment contract executed prior to the start date are exempt from in-person attendance, subject to advance written approval by the Head of People Operations.

4. Home Office Equipment and Broadband Allowance

To ensure remote workspaces satisfy ergonomic and productivity baselines, Apex provides financial assistance:

- **Initial Setup Reimbursement:** A one-time tax-free stipend of up to $750 for home office furniture (ergonomic desk chair, external 4K monitor, keyboard, mouse, or desk riser). Expense claims must be submitted via Expensify within 60 days of hire with itemized receipts.
- **Monthly Internet Subsidy:** A recurring monthly allowance of $50 added directly to payroll to offset high-speed commercial broadband expenses. Remote employees must maintain broadband connectivity with at least 50 Mbps download and 15 Mbps upload speeds.

5. Working Hours, Availability, and Communication Etiquette

- **Core Collaboration Window:** Remote employees must be actively logged in and available on Slack and email during core hours: 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM local hub time.
- **Slack Status Accuracy:** Remote employees must maintain transparent Slack status indicators (e.g., "Active", "Focus Time / Do Not Disturb", "In a Meeting", or "Lunch").
- **Video Protocol:** Working cameras are expected during one-on-one reviews, team retrospectives, customer briefings, and quarterly all-hands meetings.

6. Information Security and Workspace Compliance

- **Mandatory Corporate VPN:** All remote connections to internal systems, databases, Git repositories, and staging clusters must route through the Palo Alto GlobalProtect Corporate VPN.
- **Dedicated Private Workspace:** Remote employees must work from an environment that prevents shoulder surfing and unauthorized viewing of confidential company or customer data. Working from public coffee shops without privacy screen filters is prohibited.
- **Asset Custody:** Non-employees (including family members and roommates) are strictly prohibited from using company-issued laptops or accessing internal networks.